outlook, has been swamped by the resurgene of a racially exclusive concept of a people and their god."[29]

Israel as the "chosen people" is a concept arbitrarily used in different contexts. For Palestinian Liberation Theology, it is themselves who are "chosen" because of God's preferential love for the oppressed.[30] Accusing the Hebrews of having dispossessed the Canaanites when settling in the Land of Israel, Jewish attachment to the land is scorned, while the oft-used expression, "indigenous Christians" portrays Palestinian Christians as the only legitimate inhabitants of the land, whose presence goes back to the time of Jesus.[31]

This vision discloses a central contradiction: if the Promised Land is truly a universalist idea, there should be no place for either for Jewish or Palestinian national claims. Furthermore, if the legitimate inhabitants of the land are the Christians, there would be no reason to support Arab nationalist aspirations, which are historically connected to Islam. Palestinian theologians seek to proclaim a universal Christian message, but they nevertheless zealously profess their Palestinian and Arab identity. Some, including Rafiq Khoury, claim that genuine Christian identity is a minority status, in which Christians would be able to spread the message of Jesus.[32] In the contemporary Middle East, driven by the forces of Islamic fanaticism, it would appear that there is little room for Christians under Muslim rule, and certainly no room at all for spreading the Christian message.

By delegitimizing Zionist conceptions of the Land of Israel and the Jewish State, Palestinian theologians define Palestinians as a "chosen people" in that they are oppressed. They also elaborate a complete liturgy of destruction and dispossession which associates Jews, Israelis, and Zionists with ancient Roman imperialists, perfidious Pharisees, and the corruptors of the Scriptures. The only Jews who escape this definition are anti-Zionist Jews, who, according to Palestinian theological thought, are able to transcend the particularistic and legalist Hebraic tradition, embracing a more humane vision of God and of Israel among the nations.[33]

THE KAIROS PALESTINE DOCUMENT

With other liberationist creeds, Palestinian theology has also elaborated a political doctrine, which serves as the inspiration for Christian activism and is enshrined in the Kairos Palestine Document, whose full title is "A moment of truth: A word of faith, hope, and love from the heart of Palestinian suffering." The statement was adopted at an international conference that took place in Bethlehem in 2009. Modelled on the Kairos South Africa Document of 1985,

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